

Ogechukwu Lauren Uchendu

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2670 S AW Grimes Blvd| Round Rock, Texas 78664

EDUCATION

Master of Public Health (Epidemiology)

East Tennessee State University, College of Public Health, 2021

Doctor of Medicine and Surgery

University of Ibadan, Nigeria – College of Medicine, 2015

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

Certified in Scrum Master, Scrum Alliance, 2021

Certified Base SAS programmer, SAS Institute, 2023

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Epidemiologist III

Texas Department of State Health Services | 2024 – Present

- Directed the development of end-to-end data processing workflow to identify elevated blood lead levels, follow-up and time to normalization ensuring alignment with public health standards.
- Led a cross-functional team in designing and implementing advance statistical analyses, including time series forecasting, ARIMA modeling to predict trends in blood lead levels across multiple counties.
- Spearheaded the creation of automated alert systems to flag forecasted exceedance of blood lead level threshold enabling proactive intervention and enhancing stakeholder communication.
- Developed and executed data driven solutions to monitor and forecast public health metrics, translating analyses into actionable insight for policy maker and stakeholders.

Key Achievements:

- Leverage data analytics and visualization tools to drive public health initiatives and streamline workflow.
- Delivered actionable insight to stakeholders for impactful decision-making.

Project Lead Epidemiologist

Tennessee Department of Health (TDH) (Renaissance Therapy Contractor) | 2022 – 2024

- Led an HRSA-funded project aimed at improving HIV viral load suppression reporting and data quality, applying advanced SAS (Macro and SQL) for comprehensive data analysis and management.
- Conducted training and workshops to enhance team skills in data handling, reporting, and analysis, ensuring alignment with federal guidelines and healthcare standards.
- Managed project timelines, resources, and deliverables to meet organizational goals and regulatory requirements.
- Coordinated with healthcare teams to implement data-driven strategies to improve patient outcomes, including program development and evaluation to enhance service delivery.

Key Achievements:

- Improved the accuracy and timeliness of HIV viral load reporting, contributing to enhanced patient care.
- Successfully led the team in aligning data management processes with federal health initiatives.

Epidemiologist and Contact Tracer Supervisor

Tennessee Department of Health (TDH) and Northeast Regional Health Office
(Medasource Contractor) | 2020 – 2022

- Supervised a team of COVID-19 investigators, ensuring compliance with health guidelines, case investigations, and contact tracing protocols.
- Analyzed data related to COVID-19 transmission and outcomes, providing actionable insights for outbreak management and public health strategies.
- Collaborated with local health authorities and stakeholders to develop outbreak control measures, policy recommendations, and health communication strategies.

- Developed and implemented standard operating procedures (SOPs) for case investigations and contact tracing, optimizing efficiency and consistency in field operations.

Key Achievements:

- Played a pivotal role in coordinating the state's response to the COVID-19 pandemic, ensuring effective communication and rapid response to outbreaks.
- Led the implementation of SOPs that streamlined contact tracing processes, improving response times and outcomes.

Research Assistant

Nursing Department, East Tennessee State University | 2019 – 2021

- Assisted in nursing research projects by conducting comprehensive literature reviews, proposal development, and statistical analysis.
- Performed data collection and management using SPSS and REDCap, ensuring compliance with ethical standards for patient confidentiality.
- Contributed to the preparation of research manuscripts and presentations for academic and clinical audiences.
- Supported the coordination of research studies in collaboration with healthcare providers, ensuring quality data collection and patient care.

Key Achievements:

- Gained proficiency in managing research projects that contributed to evidence-based best practices in healthcare.
- Assisted in the development of research proposals and manuscripts that were presented at major healthcare conferences.

Medical Project Coordinator

General Hospital Wannune and Adoose Specialist Hospital, Benue, Nigeria | 2016 – 2019

- Led HIV/AIDS prevention initiatives and community outreach programs, significantly improving community health outcomes and access to care.
- Diagnosed and treated a variety of medical conditions with a focus on chronic disease management and preventive care.
- Developed and implemented emergency medical protocols, enhancing the hospital's ability to respond to critical situations.

- Evaluated program effectiveness, providing detailed reports to key stakeholders such as USAID and WHO, influencing future healthcare funding and policies.

Key Achievements:

- Successfully designed and implemented a medical emergency unit, improving patient outcomes in critical care situations.
- Managed large-scale health initiatives, improving public health education and service access in underserved communities.

SUMMARY

Dynamic public health leader with a strong background in epidemiology, advanced analytics, project management, and behavioral health services. Skilled in managing cross-functional teams, implementing data-driven strategies, and driving initiatives to improve healthcare delivery, patient outcomes, and regulatory compliance. Expertise in leading complex health programs, analyze and interpreting data, developing and implementing policies, and coordinate with stakeholders across government agencies and healthcare organizations. Proven ability to translate insights into actionable solutions, enhance public health surveillance and shape evidence-based policymaking.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Member: CSTE, TPHA, APHA
- ETSU Alumni, ESTU Honors Society, UI Alumni

REFERENCES

Available upon request